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GADDI SPEECH COMMUNITY OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR: THE SELF-CLAIMED DESCENDANTS OF LORD SHIVA

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Abstract

Jammu and Kashmir is well known for accommodating people of diverse ethnicities that differ on the basis of language, culture and religion. Apart from major speech communities like Kashmiri and Dogri, there are some minority speech communities as well living in different parts of Jammu and Kashmir. The minority communities in this region comprise of Pahari, Gaddi, Gojri, Poguli, Tibetan etc. Owing to the fact, this entire region is linguistically and culturally divergent. One of the minority communities of the region is Gaddi speeh community of Jammu region. The present paper aims to present the different linguistic and cultural domains like language, background of the community, basic vocabulary and kinship terminology of Gaddi speech community settled in Bhaderwah area of District Doda of Jammu and Kashmir. To carry the study, a fieldwork was conducted in different villages of Bhaderwah area and data was collected through questionnaire method, interview method and observational method.

Keywords: Gaddi, linguistic diversity, kinship, vocabulary

1. Introduction

The upper belt and some neighbouring areas of the Bhaderwah tehsil of the district Doda of Jammu and Kashmir are home to the Gaddi speech community. Some of them have settled in the Jammu region's Udhampur, Bani and Kathua areas. Originally, Gaddis belonged to the region of Chamba, but some of them migrated to the region of Bhaderwah over time. There are several reasons for their migration. But the harsh winters and the persecution by the Mughal emperors are said to be the key reasons for their migration, as stated by some of the Gaddi people. Gaddi speakers can be found in as many as ten villages in Bhaderwah. The total population of Gaddis in Jammu division is around 46,400 as per the census of 2011.

Drew has talked about Gaddi community in his book *The Jummoo and Kashmir Territories: A Geographical Account*. He says, "The south-east end of Bhaderwah borders with the Chamba country, and the Gaddis living in Bhaderwah seem to have migrated at some time or other through Chamba Hills. They are Hindus and have the same subdivisions of caste as the others". (1875: 107)

2. Background

The word Gaddi, meaning shepherd, is derived from the Sanskrit word *Gaddar* which means sheep. Gaddi is a semi-pastoral and semi-cultivating tribe. Originally Gaddis belonged to the Chamba region. Some of these have migrated to Bhaderwah around two hundred years ago. There are as many as ten villages in Bhaderwah where Gaddi speakers are found.

"Most of the population works as shepherds, The Gaddi people are locally called by the name *Ghadeshi* which means "the people from the country of shepherds." Cattle rearing is considered as the main occupation of Gaddi people, thus, no matter how rich or poor a person is, everyone among the Gaddi community respects this occupation. The person having large number of cattle is considered as rich among the community. Cattle rearing is considered as respectable profession as it is the profession of their ancestors. As the Gaddi people live in the remote area they have comparatively less facilities than other communities; they cannot avail their food items very easily so they mostly prefer to grow different crops on their own soil. People belonging to the community, who have migrated from higher region to the main city of Bhaderwah, have taken up different jobs to earn their livelihood. They are also enjoying the reservation in the appointment of government jobs" (Sheikh & Dar, 2021: 49-70).

3. Religion

The Gaddi community follows Hinduism. The community, in spite of its contact with Muslims, has been able to retain and hold on to their cultural beliefs and norms with little or no modification. The religious belief of the Gaddi people revolves around the faith in Lord Shiva. While worshipping Lord Shiva is almost a common practice in Hinduism, Gaddi people differ from other Hindus in their belief towards lord Shiva. They believe that only Gaddis were allowed by the Lord Shiva to sit on his seat and that seat is called as Gaddi and they are the descendants of Lord Shiva. This belief make them the special disciples of Lord Shiva. A good number of festivals are celebrated by Gaddi people throughout the year and every festival has its own significance and importance.

Shiv Ratri (the birthday celebration of Lord Shiva) is their main festival. They also participate in the festivals of other religious communities like Muslims as the community is surrounded by Muslims. It depicts the communal harmony prevalent in the community. Muslims also participate in the festivals of their Hindu brothers.

4. Language

Gaddi is an Indo-Aryan language. Bailey (1908) classified Gaddi as a language of Western Pahari group of Indo-Aryan languages in his book *The Languages of Northern Himalayas*. The word Pahari applies to the group of languages spoken in the Sub-Himalayan hills extending from Bhaderwah to the eastern parts of the Nepal.

As mentioned above Gaddi is an Indo-Aryan language. It belongs to the Western Pahari Sub-group. The family tree of Gaddi language is as follows (Ethnologue 2014).

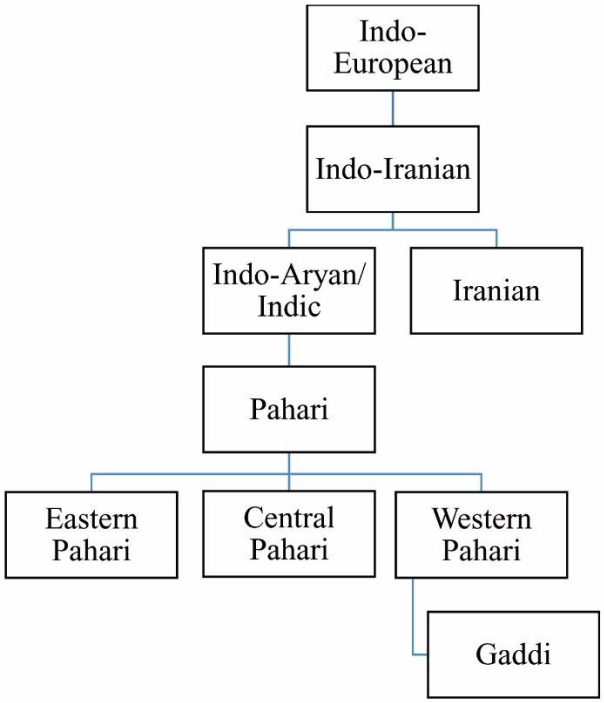


Figure 1. Family Tree of Gaddi Language

Gaddi is also known by other names, such as, Bharmauri, Bhadi, Gaddyali, Gadiali, Bharmauri. However, Gaddi is the most common name used by the speakers of the language.

4.1 Vocabulary of Gaddi Language:

4.1.1 Seasons of the Year

There are four seasons in a year and Gaddi language has own set of terms to represent each season. The names of seasons in Gaddi language are as follows:

Gaddi	**Goss**
bast	Spring
barsaːla	Summer
ʃaeːr	Autumn
hɨõːd	Winter

Table 1. Seasons of the Year

4.1.2 Months of the Year

The names of months of a year in Gaddi language are:

Gaddi	**Gloss**
tʃetar	February-March
bisaːk	March-April
dʒeːʈʰ	April-May
haːɖ	May-June
Sawni	June-July
Badu	July-August
asoːdʒ	August-September
katɨk	September-October
magʰar	October-November
Pow	November-December
maːg	December-January
pʰagən	January- February

Table 2. Months of the Year

4.1.3 Days of the Week

Gaddi language has its own set of names for days of a week. Following terms are used to denote the days of week in Gaddi language:

Gaddi	**Gloss**
somwaːr	Monday
maŋalwar	Tuesday
budʰwar	Wednesday
brestwar	Thursday
ʃukurwar	Friday
ʃaniwar	Saturday
eːtwar	Sunday

Table 3. Days of the Week

4.1.4 Number System in Gaddi Language:

The word class denoting the number system in Gaddi language is given below:

Cardinals

Gaddi	**Gloss**
akɨ	One
doːj	Two
trai	Three
tʃoːr	Four
pandʒi	Five
tʃeː	Six
satɨ	Seven
aʈʰɨ	Eight
nav	Nine
daʃ	Ten
gʲaːra	Eleven
baːraː	Twelve
teːraː	Thirteen
tʃowda	Fourteen
pandra	Fifteen
ʃola	Sixteen

sataːra	Seventeen
aʈʰara	Eighteen
uniː	Nineteen
biː	Twenty
tʃaliː	Forty
pandʒa	Fifty
ʃov	Hundred
akʰ azaːr	Thousand

Table 4. Cardinals in Gaddi

Ordinals

Gaddi	**Gloss**
pehla	First
duwa	Second
trija	Third
tʃotʰa	Forth
pandʒwa	Fifth
tʃʰaʈʰwa	Sixth
satɨwa	Seventh
aʈʰɨwa	Eighth
nawwa	Nineth
daʃwa	Tenth
bĩːwa	Twentieth
padʒama	Fiftieth
ʃawma	Hundredth

Table 5. Ordinals in Gaddi

4.1.5 Kinship

The system which is defined by the relationships between individuals having the family ties either in terms of biological relations or culturally constructed relations is called as kinship system. The kinship systems vary in different forms of social organization and each community has its own set of the terms which forms its kinship terminology.

Kinship is defined as "the system of social relationships connecting people in a culture who are or are held to be related and defining and regulating their reciprocal obligations." (Gladwin,1948: 73-94). Kinship shows relatedness between individuals or groups formulated by blood or by the bond of marriage. It can sometimes also be formulated through the process of adaptation in which one individual is related to another neither by blood nor by the marital affinity but are procreated by adapting a child. According to Brown (1952:280) "kinship is a system of dyadic relations between person and person in a community, the behavior of any two persons in any of these relations is regulated in some way and to a greater or less extent by social usage".

4.1.5.1 Types of Kinship

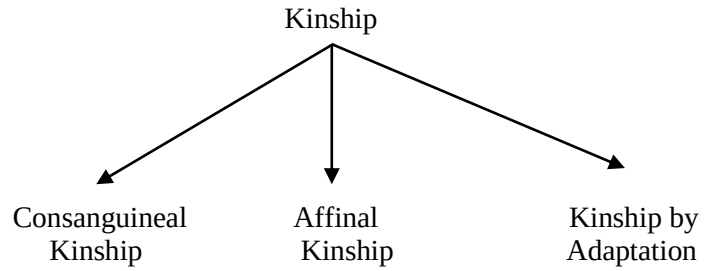


Figure 2. Types of Kinship

4.1.5.1.1 Kinship Terminology of Gaddi Language

The Gaddi language has its own collection of kinship terms for both affinal and consanguineal relationships. Most relationships are denoted by distinct terms, but some relationships are denoted by a common term, as all male cousins are typically referred to by a /ba:ji/ term, and a /dadda:/ term refers to all female cousins. The relationships set by blood and marriage in Gaddi community can be modelled as:

I. Consanguineal Relationships: The relationships which are set by blood fully or partially are consanguineal relationships. These relationships are classified on hierarchical basis from generation to generation. Consanguineal relationships comprises of:

a. **Own Generation**

The relationships of an individual's own generation include his or her brothers, sisters, and all first cousins. The relationships of one generation in the Gaddi group have a common term for brother and all male cousins

and a common term for sister and all female cousins. Like mother's sister's daughter and father's sister's daughter, Gaddi individuals are not permitted to marry their cross cousin in any way. The relationships included in own generation and their similar terms in Gaddi language are as under:

Gaddi	Addresser→ Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
ba:ji:	B/Z → B(e/y)	Brother (elder/ younger)	M	G0
dadda:	B/Z → Z(e/y)	Sister (elder/ younger)	F	G0
ba:ji:	C(M/F) → FBS	Father's Brother's Son	M	G0
dadda:	C (M/F) → FBD	Father's Brother's Daughter	F	G0
ba:ji	C(M/F) → FZS	Father's Sister's Son	M	G0
dadda:	C (M/F) → FZD	Father's Sister's Daughter	F	G0
ba:ji:	C(M/F) → MBS	Mother's Brother's Son	M	G0
dadda:	C (M/F) → MBD	Mother's Brother's Daughter	F	G0
ba:ji:	C(M/F) → MZS	Mother's Sister's Son	M	G0
dadda:	C (M/F) → MZD	Mother's Sister's Daughter	F	G0

Table 6. Own Generation Relationships

In Gaddi there are only two terms for the first generation relationship. All the male cousins are called by /ba:ji/ while as female cousins are called by /dadda:/.

b. Partial-Blood Relationship

The relationship procreated by remarrying of either of the parents of an individual is partially related by blood to that individual. These kinds of relationships later get extended after having children from newly created couple. The terminology for these kinds of relationships in Gaddi is as follows:

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
sotela: ba:pu:	S/D → XF	Step Father	M	G+1
soteli amma	S/D → XM	Step Mother	F	G+1
sotela ba:j	C → XB	Step Brother	M	G0
soteli: dada	C → XZ	Step Sister	F	G0
soteli koḍe:	C → XD	Step Daughter	F	G-1
sotela: ɡogru:	S → XS	Step Son	M	G-1

Table 7. Partial Relationships

c. First Ascending Generation

Relationships are typically established on a hierarchical basis, with an individual having relationships with ascending generations (one or more generations above them in the hierarchy). The following words form the first ascending generation:

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
ba:pu:	S/D → Fa	Father	M	G+1
tʃa:tʃa:	C → FB	Father's Brother	M	G+1
tʃa:tʃi	C → FBW	Father's Brother's Wife	F	G+1
bubbe:	C → FZ	Father's Sister	F	G+1
bubba:	C → FZH	Father's Sister's Husband	M	G+1
amma:	S/D → Mo	Mother	F	G+1
ma:m	C → MB	Mother's Brother	M	G+1
ma:mi:	C → MBW	Mother's Brother's Wife	F	G+1
ma:si:	C → MZ	Mother's Sister	F	G+1
mosaji:	C → MZH	Mother's Sister's Husband	M	G+1

Table 8. First Ascending Generation

d. Second Ascending Generation

The generation comprises of grandparents of the individual is second ascending generation. It is two generations above in hierarchy to the individual. Examples are as follows.

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
da:da:	C → FF	Father's father	M	G+2
da:di:	C → FM	Father's mother	F	G+2
da:da:	C → MF	Mother's father	M	G+2
da:di:	C → MM	Mother's mother	F	G+2

Table 9. Second Ascending Generation

e. First Descending Generation

The relation which is one generation below in the hierarchy to the individual is first descending generation. Examples are as follows.

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
gagru:	Fa/Mo → S	Son	M	G-1
koɖe:	Fa/Mo → D	Daughter	F	G-1
bʰa:ndʒ	C → BS	Brother's Son	M	G-1
bʰa:ndʒi	C → BD	Brother's Daughter	F	G-1
bʰa:ndʒ	C → ZS	Sister's Son	M	G-1
bʰa:ndʒi	C → ZD	Sister's Daughter	F	G-1

Table 10. First Descending Generation

f. Second Descending Generation

The second descending generation is the relationship that is two generations below the hierarchy with the individual. It is made up of grandsons and granddaughters. The relationships in Gaddi community's second descending generation are denoted by the following terms.

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
potru:	C → SS	Son's son	M	G-2
potri	C → SD	Son's daughter	F	G-2
potru:	C → DS	daughter's son	M	G-2
potri	C → DD	Daughter's daughter	F	G-2

Table 11. Second Descending Generation

II. Affinal Relationships: The relationships which are set by marriage are Affinal Relationships. These relationships are pro-creational in nature. In Gaddi community, the relations formed by marriage are represented by separate terms. Kinships set by marriage in Gaddi community are classified as:

Gaddi	Addresser → Addressee	Gloss	Sex	Generation
la:ɖa:	W → H	Husband	M	G0
ʃovra	W → HF	Husband's Father	M	G+1
ʃaʃu:	W → HM	Husband's Mother	F	G+1
dʒe:ʈʰ	W → HBe	Husband's Elder Brother	M	G0
de:war	W → HBy	Husband's Younger Brother	M	G0
dʒəʈʰa:n	W → HBWe	Husband's Elder Brother's Wife	F	G0
dewra:n	W → HBWy	Husband's Younger Brother's Wife	F	G0

nand	W → HZ	Husband's Sister	F	G0
ba:ji	W → HZH	Husband's Sister's Husband	M	G0
trinti, la:ɖe	H → W	Wife	F	G0
ʃovra	H → WF	Wife's Father	M	G+1
ʃaʃu:	H → WM	Wife's Mother	F	G+1
sa:la:	H → WB	Wife's Brother	M	G0
dadda:	H → WBW	Wife's Brother's wife	F	G0
sa:li:	H → WZ	Wife's Sister	F	G0
saɖiba:j	H → WZH	Wife's Sister's Husband	M	G0
nuʃ	C → DL	Daughter-in-law	F	G-1
la:ɖa:	C → SL	Son-in-law	M	G-1

Table 12. Affinal Relationships

III. Kinship by Adoption/Affiliation:

Some relationships are neither related by blood nor related by marriage but are procreated by adopting the child. In Gaddi community mostly the childless people adopts the child and it is conventional that the adopted child should belong to their own community.

Gaddi	**Addresser → Addressee**	**Gloss**	**Sex**	**Generation**
kʰokʰaleru: gagru	C → AS	Adopted Son	M	G-1
kʰokʰaleru: koɖe:	C → AD	Adopted Daughter	F	G-1

Table 13. Kinship by Adoption/Affiliation

Conclusion

Gaddi speech community of Jammu has remained the mystery to many as the no one has provided any description related to the cultural, linguistic and other aspects of the community. Although Gaddis are scattered in many parts of the country. But a good number of population is settled in the hilly terrains spread over the Chenab region of Jammu. The paper is an attempt to provide the detailed description of different cultural aspects of the Community. In this paper the researchers have given the description of the settlement, language and kinship system of the Gaddi speech community. It is hoped that this paper will pave way to carry more studies on this so far ignored community.

Notations

B	Brother
Z	Sister
e	Elder
y	Younger
C	Addresser
FBS	Father's Brother's Son
FBD	Father's Brother's Daughter
FZS	Father's Sister's Son
FZD	Father's Sister's Daughter
MBS	Mother's Brother's Son
MBD	Mother's Brother's Daughter
MZS	Mother's Sister's Son
MZD	Mother's Sister's Daughter
M	Male
F	Female
G0	Own Generation Relationships.
S	Son
D	Daughter
XF	Step Father
XM	Step Mother
XB	Step Brother
XZ	Step Sister
XD	Step Daughter
XS	Step Son
FB	Father's Brother
FBW	Father's Brother's Wife
FZ	Father's Sister
FZH	Father's Sister's Husband
MB	Mother's Brother
MBW	Mothers Brother's Wife
MZ	Mother's Sister
MZH	Mother's Sister's Husband.
G+1	First Ascending Generation.
FF	Father's Father
FM	Father's Mother

MF	Mother's Father
MM	Mother's Mother.
G+2	Second Ascending Relationships.
Fa	Father
Mo	Mother
BS	Brother's son
BD	Brother's daughter
ZS	Sister's Son
ZD	Sister's daughter
G-1	First Descending Generation
SS	Son's Son
SD	Son's Daughter
DS	Daughter's Son
DD	Daughter's Daughter
G-2	Second Descending Generation.
H	Husband
W	Wife
HF	Husband's Father
HM	Husband's Mother
HB	Husband's Brother
HBW	Husband's Brother's Wife
HZ	Husband's Sister
HZH	Husband's Sister's Husband
WF	Wife's Father
WM	Wife's Mother
WB	Wife's Brother
WZ	Wife's Sister
WBW	Wife's Brother's Wife
WZH	Wife's Sister's Husband
DL	Daughter-in-law
SL	Sister-in-law
G0	Own Generation Relationships
AS	Adopted Son
AD	Adopted Daughter

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